

DEVELOPMENTAL READING



Lumen
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Book: Developmental Reading (Lumen)

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Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Success in Reading

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Create and share a WordPress blog URL for publishing classwork.
- Operate Google Drive applications.
- Analyze an author's work for purpose.
- Explain current attitudes about writing and reading.

There's a saying, "You won't know where you are going if you don't know where you have been." At this point in your life you are on a path to *somewhere*, but *what* is that somewhere? And where are you on the path—leading or following?

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1.0: Overview

In his TED Talk, Derek Sivers discusses why it's important to have leaders, and why it's even more important to have followers.



How to Start a Movement. (Derek Sivers via TED @ <http://youtu.be/V74AxCqOTvg>).

Part of being successful, whether as a leader or follower, is preparation.

In this module, you will prepare for success in the course by exploring the technology you'll come to use often in the class, as well as prepare yourself for future success in life by expressing what your definition of success means to you.

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1.1: Assignment - Exploring Google Drive

In this assignment, you will explore and familiarize yourself with the robust suite of software called Google Drive.

Over the last few years, [Google](#) has developed some handy products students may find quite useful in college. In this course, you will use Google Drive to develop your assignments as well as collaborate with your peers. The best thing about Google Drive is it's free, easy to use, and compatible with other desktop applications.

Most students are familiar with Microsoft Office, but in order to utilize Office, you have to pay for the software (about \$100) or have access to it (via a campus computer). Another issue is accessing, saving, and backing up files. Many students find Google Drive a simple, efficient, and effective alternative to Microsoft Office because anything you create in your Google Drive is accessible on any device with an Internet connection. Also convenient is Google Drive autosaves every few seconds, so you never have to worry about losing content in your file.

Directions

1. Create a Google [Gmail account](#) (if you don't have one already).
2. Visit the Google Drive [About](#) page for an overview.
3. Review this [screencast](#) about the assignment.
4. Access your Google [email account](#).
5. Click Google Drive
6. Click Create
7. Choose Drawing
8. Create a drawing
9. Click Untitled Drawing and name the drawing
10. Set the Share settings of your Google Drawing to "Anyone with the link"
11. Copy your Google Drawing's URL
12. Log in to the online course and access the course message tool
13. Paste the URL of your Google Drawing in a message to the class and click send
14. Then paste the URL in the assignment submission on this page
15. Open at least two classmates' messages, click on their drawing links, and write a short message back to the person about what you thought about their drawing.
16. The credit for this assignment will not be in Grades until it is added by the instructor.

Grading

Points: 20

Submitting: a website URL

Exploring Google Tools KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Google drawing	Student completed Google Drawing 15 pts		Student did not complete Google Drawing 0 pts	15 pts
Messaged Google Drawing to Class	Student messaged Google Drawing 5 pts		Student did not message Google Drawing 0 pts	5 pts
Operate Google Drive applications for self and group activities	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts

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1.2: Assignment - Submit WordPress URL

This course utilizes [WordPress](#), which is a blogging tool free to anyone with a WordPress account. One of the reasons you will use WordPress to publish your work is so you retain ownership of it can easily share it with the world. In this exercise, you'll create your WordPress account and share your blog URL.

Directions

1. Visit the WordPress [sign up](#) page to create your WordPress account.
2. Take some time to [explore WordPress](#).
3. Create your WordPress blog home page.
4. Submit the URL of your blog to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 10

Submitting: a website URL

Submit Word Press Blog URL KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
WordPress Blog URL	Student submits URL 10 pts		Student does not submit URL 0 pts	10 pts
Create and share a WordPress blog URL for publishing classwork.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				10 pts

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1.3: Assignment - Literacy Narrative

For this activity, you will create a Literacy Narrative, publish your work on your WordPress blog site, then copy and paste the URL of your WordPress post into the submission window. If you have not signed up for your WordPress account, visit [Submit WordPress URL](#) for directions.

Directions

1. Develop a 500–700 word Literacy Narrative in a Google Doc.

A *literacy narrative* is the story of how you learned something significant about yourself as a reader and writer.

Think about the following:

- What is your current attitude toward reading/writing?
- What are your beliefs about yourself as a reader/writer?
- What happened in the past to make you have that attitude or those beliefs?
- What experiences were most significant?

To help you create your Literacy Narrative:

Review [Alexie's "Joy of Reading and Writing: Superman and Me"](#) (be sure to read the second web page to finish the essay).

And consider the following:

- your family's attitude toward reading/writing;
- your own reading/writing experiences in and out of school;
- what you remember about learning to read/write;
- what successes or failures you have had connected to reading/writing;
- a particular book that had an impact on you;
- your reading/writing strengths; and
- your reading/writing weaknesses.

2. Copy and paste the final version of your Literacy Narrative to a new WordPress blog post.

3. Submit the URL of your blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 50

Submitting: a website URL

Literacy Narrative KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Ideas: focused, original perspective on the topic	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 9 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Organization: structure enhances ideas and aids in understanding	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 8 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Voice: appropriate, engages the reader, and compelling	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
Word Choice: creates vivid pictures, powerful, energizing	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts

Sentence Fluency: words and phrases flow together when read aloud	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
Conventions: standard writing conventions used, few errors	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
Presentation: finished piece is easy to read, polished	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 3 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
500–700 Word Count	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 3 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
Explain current attitudes about reading and writing.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				50 pts

Contributors

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- Literacy Narrative. **Authored by:** Elisabeth Ellington and Ronda Dorsey Neugebauer. **Provided by:** Chadron State College. **Project:** Kaleidoscope Open Course Initiative. **License:** [CC BY: Attribution](#)

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: What It Means to be a Good Reader

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Distinguish individual learning styles and interpret learning strategies for success.
- Describe the reading process used by proficient readers to comprehend text.
- Identify topics, main ideas, and supporting details in texts.
- Apply strategies for improving writing responses.

Some might think of good readers as those for whom reading seems to come easily—the students who always make good grades in English and high scores on standardized reading tests. What is interesting, though, is even the best readers struggle when reading texts—the difference is good readers know how to struggle successfully. They read actively, think critically, apply various comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading, recognize when they don't understand what they're reading, and know strategies for repairing meaning. In addition, just as practice in sports, for example, improves an athlete's performance, so does practice in reading. In essence, the key to being a good reader is to practice good reading strategies.

[2.1: Overview](#)

[2.2: What Type of Learner are You?](#)

[2.3: Discussion Board - VARK Learning Questionnaire](#)

[2.4: Assignment - Pre-Reading Strategies](#)

[2.5: Assignment - Improving Writing with Literacy Narrative](#)

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2.1: Overview

Take a moment to listen to a poetry recitation by Lamont Carey called “I Can’t Read” from HBO’s *Def Poetry* series:



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2.2: What Type of Learner are You?

What Type of Learner are You?



It is your first day in a new apartment and you decide to buy a new desk for your college studies. You drive out to the furniture store and find a decent yet affordable desk to purchase. You and the salesperson strike up a conversation about the rising cost of higher education, and the salesperson offers you a deal on the desk if you agree to buy it unassembled. You figure with the savings you could buy a new pair of those ridiculously expensive (but oh so stylish!) headphones that you MUST have. You agree to buy the desk unassembled, borrow some tools from the handyperson next door, break out a little elbow grease, and haul the desk unassembled and still boxed into your apartment.

So what do you do next?

- Do you open the box, find the written assembly instructions, and get to reading?
- Do you open the box, find the diagram assembly instructions, and analyze the pictures?
- Do you open the box, throw out the instructions, and start putting the desk together?
- Do you wait for your roommate to get home and discuss an assembly “plan of attack”?
- Do you do a combination of the aforementioned?
- Or do you just call someone else to do it for you?

Most of the time we concentrate on what we are learning rather than how we are learning it. Yet, to get the most out of our learning experiences, we need to be aware of and engage in the actual process of how we are learning.

Learning how we learn is important for our success in college and beyond. Unfortunately, no single method of learning guarantees our success—we must find the methods that best suit our learning for ourselves.

Contributors

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- Desk-CRW_8337. **Authored by:** Anton Olsen. **Located at:** <https://flic.kr/p/4uaTMf>. **License:** [CC BY-NC: Attribution-NonCommercial](#). **License Terms:** Creative Commons Attribution-Non Commercial 2.0 Generic

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2.3: Discussion Board - VARK Learning Questionnaire

One of the ways to understand how we learn best is to complete an inventory of our learning styles. For this exercise, you will utilize the VARK Learning Questionnaire, complete an inventory of your learning style, review the inventory results, and discuss whether the inventory was spot on or way off for your learning style.

Directions

1. Visit the [VARK Learning Styles Inventory](#).
2. Read each statement and answers and click on the answer(s) that most apply to you. You may click more than one answer and there are no right or wrong answers.
3. Submit your results by clicking the OK button.
4. Review your VARK results by clicking on the underlined learning style for a list of learning strategies recommended for your learning type(s).
5. Copy and paste the learning strategies recommendation into a Google Doc.
6. Develop first in your Google Doc a discussion post that addresses:
 - Which area(s) of learning were you strongest in? Does this surprise you?
 - Describe the Intake, SWOT, and Output Study Strategies suggested for your Learning (this will make sense to you once you complete the questionnaire and review the results).
 - What are three of the SWOT (Study WithOut Tears) strategies you might like to try? How do you think it will aid you in studying?
 - Do you think this questionnaire helped you learn more about how best you learn? Why or why not?
7. Copy and paste your post in the discussion.
8. Review your classmates' posts.
9. Respond to your classmates' posts about the knowledge you gained from the inventory.

Grading

VARK Learning Questionnaire KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Primary Post	Student addresses all directions; meets the 200 word count; and posts on time 10 pts	Student addresses some of the directions, and/or posts under 200 words 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Distinguish individual learning styles to interpret learning strategies for success.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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2.4: Assignment - Pre-Reading Strategies

This assignment about pre-reading strategies is a class activity using a Google Docs spreadsheet.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Access the [Google Doc spreadsheet](#).
3. Add your first and last name to a row in the Google Doc.
4. Using the Internet, conduct a search for Pre-Reading Strategies.
5. Find 3 useful Pre-Reading Strategies webpages and copy and paste the URLs into your row of the Google Doc.
6. Choose 3 Pre-Reading Strategies (either the ones you picked and/or others added by classmates) from the spreadsheet to practice using in your other classes.
7. Write a paragraph of at least 100 words describing the 3 Pre-Reading Strategies you will practice.
8. Add this paragraph to the Pre-Reading Strategies Google Doc (be sure to include a word count).
9. Practice using the strategies in your other classes.
10. Write a paragraph of at least 100 words summarizing your experience with using the 3 Pre-Reading Strategies.
11. Add this paragraph to the Pre-Reading Strategies spreadsheet (be sure to include a word count).
12. The credit for this assignment will not be in Grades until it is added by the instructor.

Grading

Points: 30

Submitting: nothing

Pre-Reading Strategies KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Describe the reading process used by proficient readers to comprehend text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Student identified 3 pre-reading strategies	Full marks 10 pts		No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Student discusses how they will practice 3 pre-reading strategies	Full marks 10 pts		No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Student summarizes experience of using 3 pre-reading strategies	Full marks 10 pts		No marks 0 pts	10 pts
TOTAL POINTS				30 pts

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2.5: Assignment - Improving Writing with Literacy Narrative

For this assignment, improve your Literacy Narrative using feedback from the instructor.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Review Grades for feedback on your [Literacy Narrative](#). The feedback will highlight topics for you to develop in your writing.
3. Create a report in a Google Doc detailing the following:
 - The area(s) at issue to develop in your writing (as noted in the Literacy Narrative feedback).
 - Conduct Internet research for this issue (at least 3 sources and copy and paste the URLs into your Google Doc)
 - Summarize your research into a 100 word paragraph.
 - Copy and paste your original Literacy Narrative into your Google Doc below the summary you completed.
 - Revise your Literacy Narrative in the Google Doc using the knowledge you gained from writing the report.
4. Set the share settings of the Google Doc to “Anyone with the link.”
5. Submit the URL of your Google Doc to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 50

Submitting: a website URL

Improving Writing with Literacy Narrative KEEP			
Criteria	Ratings		Points
Evidence student has reviewed feedback in grades	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Student selected an issue to improve in their Literacy Narrative	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Summary of research regarding the issue is included (with URL references)	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Original Literacy Narrative is pasted below summary of research	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts

Student revises Literacy Narrative with respect to the issue as identified	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts			10 pts
Apply strategies for improving writing responses	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts	
TOTAL POINTS					50 pts

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Active Reading

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Apply effective reading strategies used by proficient readers before, during, and after reading text.
- Explore attitudes about academic writing.
- Explain the elements of the writing process.

Proficient readers use a variety of strategies before, during, and after reading to help them comprehend and appreciate written texts. In this module, we will learn about reading actively and recursively and also apply a variety of strategies to improve vocabulary, which is an essential foundation for reading comprehension.

[3.1: Overview](#)

[3.2: Active Reading](#)

[3.3: Assignment - Active Reading in Action](#)

[3.4: Assignment - Improving Vocabulary](#)

[3.5: Discussion Board - Views of Writing](#)

[3.6: Assignment - Writing Process](#)

Thumbnail: <https://www.pexels.com/photo/person-...-book-2898870/>

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3.1: Overview

Review this video discussing before, during, and after reading strategies.



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3.2: Active Reading

One of the greatest challenges students face is adjusting to college reading expectations. Unlike high school, students in college are expected to read more “academic” type of materials in less time and usually recall the information as soon as the next class.

The problem is many students will spend hours reading and have no idea what they just read. Their eyes are moving across the page, but their mind is somewhere else. The end result is wasted time, energy, and frustration . . . and having to read the text again.

Although students are taught *how to read* at an early age, many are not taught *how to actively engage* with written text.

Active Reading is applying reading strategies before, during, and after reading a text with the overall objective of increasing comprehension (understanding what was read) and recall (remembering what was read) to save time and effort.

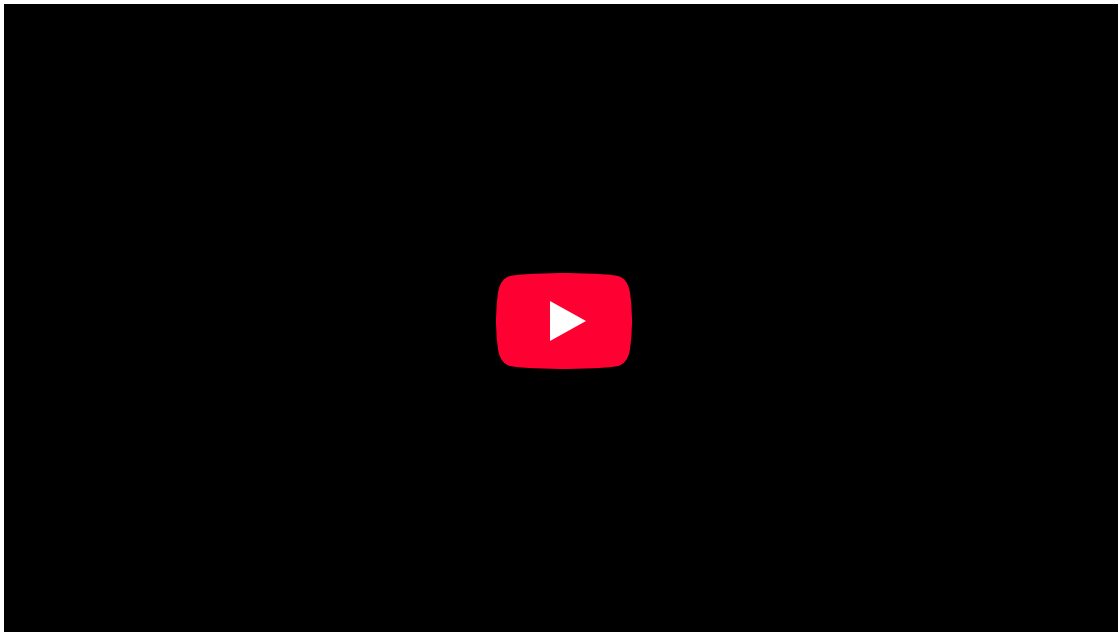
The Secret is in the Pen

One of the ways proficient readers read is with a pen in hand. They know their purpose is to keep their attention on the material by:

- *predicting* what the material will be about
- *questioning* the material to further understanding
- *determining* what’s important
- *identifying* key vocabulary
- *summarizing* the material in their own words, and
- *monitoring* their comprehension (understanding) during and after engaging with the material

Annotating a Text

Review this video about “Learning How to Annotate” to develop active reading strategies:



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Review Oberlin College and Conservatory’s [“Keeping a Reading Journal”](#) page.

And Dustin Wax’s [“Keep an Academic Reading Journal”](#) to develop reading comprehension strategies.

Contributors

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- Learning how to Annotate. **Authored by:** Gale Shirey. **Provided by:** Southwestern Michigan College. **Located at:** <http://youtu.be/zy45es1HyO0>. **License:** *Other*. **License Terms:** Standard YouTube license

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3.3: Assignment - Active Reading in Action

For this activity, you will demonstrate how to apply active reading strategies to texts.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Review the strategies listed on the [Active Reading](#) page.
3. Choose two texts from other classes to apply the active reading strategies.
4. Apply the Annotate a Text strategy from [Active Reading](#) to one of the texts.
5. Apply the Reading Journal strategy from [Active Reading](#) to the other text.
6. Create a digital file (take a picture or scan) and upload the image(s) to your computer
7. Submit the image to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 40

Submitting: a file upload

Active Reading in Action KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Annotate a Text Strategy	Excellent Application of Strategy 20 pts	Developing Application of Strategy 15 pts	No annotated text 0 pts	20 pts
Reading Journal Strategy	Excellent Application of Strategy 20 pts	Developing Application of Strategy 15 pts	No reading journal 0 pts	20 pts
Apply effective reading strategies used by proficient readers before, during, and after reading text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				40 pts

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3.4: Assignment - Improving Vocabulary

Vocabulary is an important part of reading comprehension. The more we read, the more vocabulary words we will recognize. In fact, the best way to develop a rich vocabulary is to read widely and frequently.

Proficient readers also use strategies for dealing with unfamiliar words. They continue to build their vocabularies through effective use of:

- the dictionary
- context clues, and
- common prefixes, suffixes, and roots.

For this activity, you will choose a text for another class and apply vocabulary strategies (chosen from your Internet research) to 10 words from your reading selection.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Using Internet resources, research strategies for improving vocabulary related to dictionary, context clues, and common prefixes/suffixes/roots.
3. Choose a substantial (5 pages or more) reading from another class.
4. Cite the reading source using either MLA or APA formatting (use [WriteCite](#) to assist you if needed).
5. Select 10 vocabulary words from the reading.
6. Apply the vocabulary strategies to the 10 words.
7. Create a matrix schedule (similar to the one below) in a [Google Spreadsheet](#).
8. Set the Google Spreadsheet share permissions to “Anyone with the link.”
9. Submit the URL of your Google Spreadsheet to your instructor.

Matrix Schedule: Improving Vocabulary ☆

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Help All changes saved in Drive

Comments Share

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Citation for Reading (in APA or MLA):	(2011). Rhizomatic Learning – Why we teach? Dave's Educational Blog. Retrieved February 4, 2013, from http://davecormier.com/edblog/2011/11/05/rhizomatic-learning-why-learn/ .						
2	Vocabulary Word	Sentence from Reading	Dictionary.com			Context Clues	Prefix/Suffix/Root	
3	rhizome	A rhizome, sometimes called a creeping rootstalk, is a stem of a plant that sends out roots and shoots as it spreads.	rhiz-ome [rah-y-zohm] Show IPA noun <i>rhizom</i>; a rootlike subterranean stem, commonly horizontal in position, that usually produces roots below and sends up shoots progressively from the upper surface. Origin: 1835–45; < Neo-Latin <i>rhizoma</i> < Greek <i>rhizōma</i> root, stem, noun of result from <i>rhizōn</i> to fix firmly, take root, derivative of <i>rhiza</i> root Related forms rhizom-a-tous [rah-y-zohm-uh-tuh s, -zoh-muh-] Show IPA adjective			Definition also in the sentence itself; commas are a clue the definition was coming	No prefix, no suffix, root is Latin "rhizoma"	
4								
5								
6								

Example Matrix Schedule for Improving Vocabulary in Google Spreadsheet

Grading

Points: 45

Submitting: a website URL

Improving Vocabulary KEEP		
Criteria	Ratings	Points

Sentence from Reading with Vocab Word	10 words 10 pts	9 words 9 pts	8 words 8 pts	7 words 7 pts	6 words 6 pts	5 words 5 pts	4 or < words 0 pts	10 pts
Dictionary Strategy	10 words 10 pts	9 words 9 pts	8 words 8 pts	7 words 7 pts	6 words 6 pts	5 words 5 pts	4 or < words 0 pts	10 pts
Context Clues Strategy	10 words 10 pts	9 words 9 pts	8 words 8 pts	7 words 7 pts	6 words 6 pts	5 words 5 pts	4 or < words 0 pts	10 pts
Prefix/Suffix/Root Strategy	10 words 10 pts	9 words 9 pts	8 words 8 pts	7 words 7 pts	6 words 6 pts	5 words 5 pts	4 or < words 0 pts	10 pts
APA or MLA Citation of Reading Selection	Correct citation 5 pts				Incorrect or no citation 0 pts			5 pts
Apply effective reading strategies used by proficient readers before, during, and after reading text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts		Meets expectations 0 pts		Does not meet expectations 0 pts			0 pts
TOTAL POINTS								45 pts

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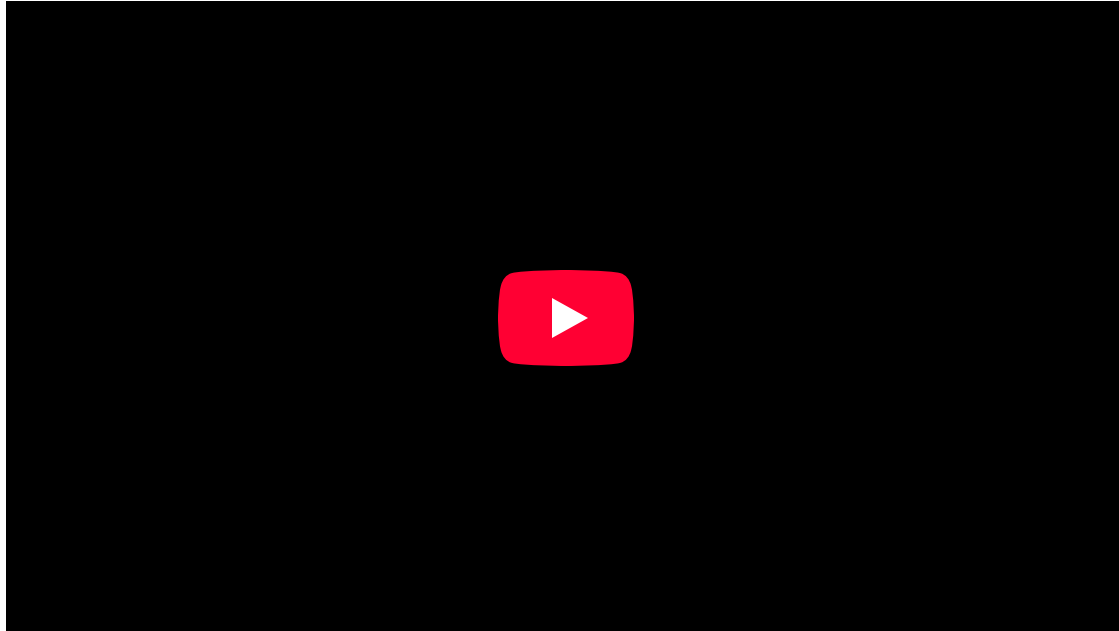
3.5: Discussion Board - Views of Writing

Reading and writing go hand-in-hand. Generally speaking, proficient students don't read without writing, and don't write without reading. The two processes although not the same are intertwined and in many ways dependent on the other.

For this discussion, take time to consider how you feel about writing, what kind of writing do you do, and how you approach academic writing assignments.

Directions

1. Review "I Hate Writing":



2. Develop first in your Google Doc a discussion post that addresses:
 - How do you feel about writing? what do you enjoy? what do you hate?
 - What emotions surface when you are assigned academic writings for your classes?
 - What other types of writing do you do?
 - How would you describe your process of writing?
 - What did you think about the "I Hate Writing" video?
 - Do you agree or disagree with the claims made in the video "I Hate Writing"?
 - Did the video cause you to think differently about writing?
3. Copy and paste your post in the discussion.
4. Review your classmates' posts.

5. Respond to your classmates' posts about how they feel about writing and whether there are similarities or differences with your views.

Grading

Views of Writing KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Primary Post	Student addresses all directions; meets the 200 word count; and posts on time 10 pts	Student addresses some of the directions, and/or posts under 200 words 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Explore attitudes about academic writing.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

Contributors

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- I Hate Writing. **Authored by:** T.R. Johnson. **Provided by:** Tulane University. **Located at:** <http://youtu.be/NvIYAcUGJDU>.
License: Other. **License Terms:** Standard YouTube license

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3.6: Assignment - Writing Process

The writing process is different for every person and for every writing type, but there are common steps that are important to practice. Generally, the writing process consists of:

- *Prewriting* (the early planning stages often as mindmapping, brainstorming, freewriting)
- *Organizing* (developing logical order)
- *Drafting* (creating the paper and demonstrating the recursive or “circling back” nature of writing)
- *Revising* (conforming to Standard Edited English and style formatting, such as MLA and APA, for most academic writing)
- *Publishing* (the final version that is submitted)

For this assignment, you will create a summary of the writing process from a proficient writer’s perspective in a Google Doc.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Answer the following questions in a Google Doc:
 1. Locate a source that defines the WRITING PROCESS. Copy and paste the URL in the submission window. Then describe the writing process using your own words.
 2. Locate a source that describes PREWRITING. Copy and paste the URL in the submission window. Then use your own words to define prewriting.
 3. Locate a source that describes ORGANIZATION as part of the writing process. Copy and paste the URL in the submission window. Then use your own words to define organization as it pertains to the writing process.
 4. Locate a source that describes DRAFTING as part of the writing process. Copy and paste the URL in the submission window. Then use your own words to define drafting as it pertains to the writing process.
 5. Locate a source that describes REVISING as part of the writing process. Copy and paste the URL in the submission window. Then use your own words to define revising as it pertains to the writing process.
 6. Locate a source that describes the RECURSIVENESS as it pertains to writing. Copy and paste the URL in the submission window. Then use your own words to describe what the recursive nature of writing means to you.
3. Copy and paste your final answers into a new WordPress blog post.
4. Submit the URL of your blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Views of Writing KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Students identify URL addresses for each stage of the Writing Process	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 3 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
Students summarize the source of each stage of the Writing Process in their own words	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 3 pts	No marks 0 pts	5 pts
Student demonstrates understanding of the recursive nature of writing	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Explain the elements of the writing process.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Reading to Understand

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Apply reading strategies when reading difficult material.
- Identify how to avoid plagiarism and how to cite sources.
- Create a summary of a text.

The foundation of all reading experiences is comprehension. Even when we're reading for pleasure and entertainment, we must first be able to comprehend the writer's meaning before we can enjoy or appreciate his or her story or style. Proficient readers understand that all texts don't give up their meaning easily and vary their reading speed and strategies according to the demands of each individual text. Proficient readers monitor their comprehension and apply fix-up strategies to repair meaning when it breaks down. Summarizing a text is one of the most effective strategies for monitoring comprehension: when you can accurately summarize what a text is saying, you can be assured that you have understood its meaning.

[4.2: Discussion Board - Reading Difficult Material](#)

[4.3: Discussion Board - Academic Writing](#)

[4.4: Assignment - Writing a Summary](#)

Thumbnail: <https://www.pexels.com/photo/man-rea...-book-2861797/>

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4.2: Discussion Board - Reading Difficult Material

After reviewing the [study strategies about reading difficult material](#), engage in a discussion with your classmates about reading strategies.

Directions

1. Review the material in the [Study Guides and Strategies for Reading Difficult Material](#) page.
2. Develop first in a new Google Doc a discussion post that addresses:
 - the ways the reading strategies you have used before worked for you and/or didn't work for you,
 - which new reading strategies you learned about that you might use to help you understand difficult text,
 - why you think the new strategy will assist you,
 - which reading strategies you learned about that you might recommend to a friend, and
 - how you might change a reading strategy you learned about to better fit your needs.
3. Copy and paste your post in the discussion.
4. Review your classmates' posts.
5. Respond to your classmates' posts about the strategies they found useful and whether or not you might use those strategies to understand difficult material.

Grading

Reading Difficult Material KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Primary Post	Student addresses all directions; meets the 200 word count; and posts on time 10 pts	Student addresses some of the directions, and/or posts under 200 words 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Apply reading strategies when reading difficult material.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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4.3: Discussion Board - Academic Writing

For this discussion, review [“What is Academic Writing” by L. L. Irvine](#), then

Directions

1. Print and annotate the chapter [“What is Academic Writing” by L. L. Irvine](#).
2. Develop first in a new Google Doc a discussion post that addresses:
 - What are your thoughts about the essay “Writing Spaces” by L. Levin Irvine?
 - What did you learn about the nature of argument and analysis in college writing tasks?
 - What do you think about Irvine’s advice about the common types of writing assignments college writers might expect to encounter?
 - What are your personal writing experiences with academic writing? Tell us about a positive academic writing experience and a negative academic writing experience that stand out for you.
3. Copy and paste your post in the discussion.
4. Review your classmates’ posts.
5. Respond to your classmates’ posts about what they thought about Irvine’s chapter as well as the writing experiences they’ve accrued thus far.

Grading

Academic Writing KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Primary Post	Student addresses all directions; meets the 200 word count; and posts on time 10 pts	Student addresses some of the directions, and/or posts under 200 words 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates’ primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate’s primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Apply reading strategies when reading difficult material.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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4.4: Assignment - Writing a Summary

Proficient students understand that *summarizing*, identifying what is most important and restating the text in your own words, is an important tool for college success.

After all, if you really know a subject, you will be able to summarize it. If you cannot summarize a subject, even if you have memorized all the facts about it, you can be absolutely sure that you have not learned it. And, if you truly learn the subject, you will still be able to summarize it months or years from now.

Proficient students may monitor their understanding of a text by summarizing as they read. They understand that if they can write a one- or two-sentence summary of each paragraph after reading it, then that is a good sign that they have correctly understood it. If they can not summarize the main idea of the paragraph, they know that comprehension has broken down and they need to use fix-up strategies to repair understanding.

Summarizing consists of two important skills:

1. identifying the important material in the text, and
2. restating the text in your own words.

Since writing a summary consists of omitting minor information, it will always be shorter than the original text.

How to Write a Summary

- A summary begins with an *introductory sentence* that states the text's title, author and main thesis or subject.
- A summary contains the main *thesis* (or main point of the text), restated in your own words.
- A summary is *written in your own words*. It contains few or no quotes.
- A summary is *always shorter than the original text*, often about 1/3 as long as the original. It is the ultimate "fat-free" writing. An article or paper may be summarized in a few sentences or a couple of paragraphs. A book may be summarized in an article or a short paper. A very large book may be summarized in a smaller book.
- A summary should *contain all the major points* of the original text, but should *ignore most of the fine details*, examples, illustrations or explanations.
- The backbone of any summary is formed by *critical information* (key names, dates, places, ideas, events, words and numbers). A summary must never rely on vague generalities.
- If you quote anything from the original text, even an unusual word or a catchy phrase, you need to put whatever you quote in quotation marks ("").
- A summary must contain only the ideas of the original text. *Do not insert* any of *your own opinions, interpretations, deductions or comments* into a summary.
- A summary, like any other writing, has to have a specific audience and purpose, and you must carefully write it to serve that audience and fulfill that specific purpose.

Directions

1. Download [About Mothers and Other Monsters](#).
2. Choose an essay from the book.
3. Using the information above, write a summary of the essay in a new Google Doc.
4. Copy and paste your chapter summary to a new WordPress blog post.
5. Submit the URL of your WordPress blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 50

Submitting: a website URL

Writing a Summary KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Text chosen	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	No text chosen 0 pts	5 pts

Introductory Sentence: Title, Author, Thesis	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 4 pts		No intro sentence 0 pts	10 pts
Written in Student's Own Words	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts		From the text itself 0 pts	10 pts
Includes Main Points of Text	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts		Missing or too many details 0 pts	10 pts
Does Not Include Student's Opinions	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 3 pts		Includes opinions 0 pts	5 pts
Summary about 1/3 of original text	Yes 5 pts		No 0 pts		5 pts
Standard Edited English	Few or no errors 5 pts	Errors, but meaning is intact 4 pts		Errors affect understanding 0 pts	5 pts
Create a summary of a text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts		Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS					50 pts

Contributors

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

5: Reading to Respond

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Analyze a text for purpose and intended meaning.
- Analyze a text for text-to-self, text-to-text, and text-to-world connections.
- Participate in a peer discussion of literature.
- Create a Reader Response to text.

Proficient readers read not just to understand and question but also to respond. In fact, response is a major component of most college-level reading assignments: your professors expect you to interact more deeply with texts, to engage with their ideas, to agree with some ideas and disagree with others, to be able to “talk back” by formulating and explaining your own position. When you respond to a text, you show that you have understood it, but even more importantly, you show that you have connected with it and made it your own.

[5.2: Making Connections](#)

[5.3: Assignment - Making Connections with Us and Them](#)

[5.4: Writing a Reading Response](#)

[5.5: Assignment - Reading Response Us and Them](#)

[5.6: Assignment - Reading Response Student Choice](#)

[5.7: Discussion Board - Reading Response Feedback](#)

Thumbnail: <https://pixabay.com/photos/study-law...learn-2746004/>

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5.2: Making Connections

Can you connect with the what you are reading? Can you imagine yourself in it? Does it remind you of things from your life?

The process of reading is when a person reads text and their inner voice makes connections between the words, and their life and prior knowledge. The more closely the reader connects to the text, the higher the level of comprehension. At times connecting is simple. At others, especially when the text is not in an area that the reader has background knowledge, comprehension is difficult. To be a better reader, think about how the story relates to your life.

Connecting with Text

Readers should concentrate on their inner voice and connections.

- *Visualize.* Picture yourself in the story and think about how the setting and characters look.
- *Focus on the characters.* Compare them to yourself and people you know.
- *Put yourself in the story* and think about how would react, and how you reacted when you were in a similar situation.
- *Look at problems.* How do they compare to problems you have faced?
- *Ask yourself questions as you read.* Think about how the story relates to your life, and things that you know.
- When reading nonfiction, *think about ways the information relates to what you already know.*
- If you are reading a book, and don't connect with it, ditch it and find one where you can *make connections.*

Here are the start to connections.

Text-to-Self

This is similar to my life . . .

This is different from my life . . .

Something like this happened to me when . . .

This reminds me of . . .

This relates to me . . .

When I read this I felt . . .

Text-to-Text

This reminds me of another book I've read . . .

This is similar to another thing I read . . .

This different from another book I read . . .

This character is similar/different to another character . . .

This setting is similar/different to an other setting . . .

This problem is similar/different to the problem in . . .

Text-to-World

This reminds me of the real world . . .

This book is similar to things that happen in the real world . . .

This book is different from things that happen in the real world . . .

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- Reading Strategies, Making Connections. **Authored by:** Mr. McGuire. **Provided by:** The Reading Workshop. **Located at:** <http://www.thereadingworkshop.com/2011/10/reading-strategies-making-connections.html>. **License:** [CC BY-NC-SA: Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike](#)

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5.3: Assignment - Making Connections with Us and Them

After reviewing the [Making Connections](#) page, actively read David Sedaris's [Us and Them](#), practice annotating the text, and practice making connections with the text.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Review [Making Connections](#).
3. Print and annotate David Sedaris's [Us and Them](#).
4. Open a new Google Doc, title it with your First Name, Last Name, and Making Connections with Us and Them.
5. Set the Google Doc share permissions to "Anyone with the link."
6. Copy and paste the sentence stems below into your Google Doc.
7. Practice making connections with *Us and Them* by completing the sentence stems in your Google Doc.
8. Submit the URL of your Google Doc to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 30

Submitting: a website URL

Argument Final KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Text-to-Self connections	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 6 pts	No connections 0 pts	10 pts
Text-to-Text connections	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 6 pts	No connections 0 pts	10 pts
Text-to-World connections	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 6 pts	No connections 0 pts	10 pts
Analyze a text for text-to-self, text-to-text, and text-to-world connections	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				30 pts

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5.4: Writing a Reading Response

A reading response asks the reader [you] to examine, explain and defend your personal reaction to a reading.

You will be asked to explore:

- why you like or dislike the reading,
- explain whether you agree or disagree with the author,
- identify the reading's purpose, and
- critique the text.

There is no right or wrong answer to a reading response. Nonetheless, it is important that you demonstrate an understanding of the reading and clearly explain and support your reactions.

Write as an Educated Adult

When writing a reader response write as an educated adult addressing other adults or fellow scholars. As a beginning scholar, if you write that something has nothing to do with you or does not pass *your* “Who cares?” test, but many other people think that it is important and great, readers will probably *not* agree with you that the *text* is dull or boring, but they may conclude instead that *you* are dull and boring, that you are too immature or uneducated to understand what important things the author wrote.

Criticize with Examples

If you did not like a text, that is fine, but criticize it either from principle (it is racist, or it unreasonably puts down religion or women or working people or young people or gays or Texans or plumbers, it includes factual errors or outright lies, it is too dark and despairing, or it is falsely positive) or from form (it is poorly written, it contains too much verbal “fat,” it is too emotional or too childish, has too many facts and figures or has many typos in the text, or wanders around without making a point). In each of these cases, *do not* simply criticize, but **give examples**. But, always beware, as a beginning scholar, of criticizing any text as “confusing” or “crazy,” since readers might simply conclude that *you* are too ignorant or slow to understand and appreciate it!

Mention the Title, Author, Main Thesis

First of all, be sure to mention the *title* of the work to which you are responding, the *author*, and the *main thesis* of the text, using *correct English* for the first paragraph of your paper.

Connect to the Text

Then, try to answer ALL of the questions below. Remember, however, that you are writing an essay, not filling out a short-answer worksheet. You do not need to work through these questions in order, one by one, in your essay. Rather, your paper as a whole should be sure to address these questions in some way.

What does the text have to do with you, personally, and with your life (past, present or future)? It is not acceptable to write that the text has NOTHING to do with you, since just about everything humans can write has to do in some way with every other human.

How much does the text agree or clash with your view of the world, and what you consider right and wrong? Use several quotes as examples of how it agrees with and supports what you think about the world, about right and wrong, and about what you think it is to be human. Use quotes and examples to discuss how the text disagrees with what you think about the world and about right and wrong.

What did you learn, and how much were your views and opinions challenged or changed by this text, if at all? Did the text communicate with you? Why or why not? Give examples of how your views might have changed or been strengthened (or perhaps, of why the text failed to convince you, the way it is). Please do not write “I agree with everything the author wrote,” since everybody disagrees about something, even if it is a tiny point. Use quotes to illustrate your points of challenge, or where you were persuaded, or where it left you cold.

How well does the text address things that you, personally, care about and consider important to the world? How does it address things that are important to your family, your community, your ethnic group, to people of your economic or social class or background, or your faith tradition? If not, who does or did the text serve? Did it pass the “Who cares?” test? Use quotes to illustrate.

What can you praise about the text? What problems did you have with it? Reading and writing “critically” does not mean the same thing as “criticizing,” in everyday language (complaining or griping, fault-finding, nit-picking). Your “critique” can and should be positive and praise the text if possible, as well as pointing out problems, disagreements and shortcomings.

How well did you enjoy the text (or not) as entertainment or as a work of art? Use quotes or examples to illustrate the quality of the text as art or entertainment. Of course, be aware that some texts are not meant to be entertainment or art: a news report or textbook, for instance, may be neither entertaining or artistic, but may still be important and successful.

To sum up, what is your overall reaction to the text? Would you read something else like this, or by this author, in the future or not? Why or why not? To whom would you recommend this text?

Contributors

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- How to Write a Reaction Paper or Reader Response. **Authored by:** Owen M. Williamson. **Provided by:** University of Texas El Paso. **Located at:** <http://utminers.utep.edu/omwilliamson/engl0310/readerresponse.htm>. **License:** [CC0: No Rights Reserved](#)

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5.5: Assignment - Reading Response Us and Them

For this assignment, practice creating a Reading Response essay with David Sedaris's [Us and Them](#).

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Review the [Writing a Reading Response](#) page.
3. Print and annotate David Sedaris's [Us and Them](#).
4. Open a new Google Doc, title it with your First Name, Last Name, and "Reading Response with Us and Them."
5. Set the Google Doc share permissions to "Anyone with the link."
6. Practice writing a reading response with Sedaris's *Us and Them* in your Google Doc:
In the first paragraph of your reading response, mention the title, author, and main thesis of *Us and Them*. Then connect to the Text by answering:
 - What does the text have to do with you, personally, and with your life (past, present or future)?
 - How much does the text agree or clash with your view of the world, and what you consider right and wrong?
 - What did you learn, and how much were your views and opinions challenged or changed by this text, if at all?
 - How well does the text address things that you, personally, care about and consider important to the world?
 - What can you praise about the text? What problems did you have with it?
 - How well did you enjoy the text (or not) as entertainment or as a work of art?
 - To sum up, what is your overall reaction to the text?
7. Copy and paste the final version of your essay to a new WordPress blog post.
8. Submit the URL of your blog to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 80

Submitting: a website URL

Reading Response Us and Them KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
First line includes title, author, main thesis	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No reference to text 0 pts	10 pts
Connect text to you and life	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Connect text to view of world/right and wrong	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Learned from text	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Connect text to what is important to the world	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Praise/Problems with text	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts

Enjoy/Not Enjoy	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Overall reaction	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 7 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Analyze a text for purpose and intended meaning	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Create a Reader Response to text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				80 pts

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- How to Write a Reaction Paper or Reader Response. **Authored by:** Owen M. Williamson. **Provided by:** University of Texas El Paso. **Located at:** <http://utminers.utep.edu/omwilliamson/engl0310/readerresponse.htm>. **License:** [CC0: No Rights Reserved](#)

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5.6: Assignment - Reading Response Student Choice

For this assignment, create a Reader Response about a text of your choice.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Choose any text to read.
Feel free to find a text at one of these free reading sites:
 - [BookRix](#)
 - [10 Wonderful Short Stories to Read for Free Online](#)
 - [10 More Wonderful Short Stories to Read for Free Online](#)
 - [Classic Short Stories](#)
 - [Free Audio Books](#)
3. Review and utilize the strategies listed on the [Making Connections](#) and [Writing a Reading Response](#) pages.
4. Create a Reading Response of the text of your choice in 400–600 words in a new Google Doc.
5. Copy and paste your Reading Response Student Choice in a new post on your WordPress blog.
6. Submit the URL of your WordPress blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 100

Submitting: a website URL

Reading Response Student Choice KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
First line includes title, author, main thesis	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 2 pts	No reference to text 0 pts	10 pts
Connect text to you and life	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Connect text to view of world/right and wrong	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Learned from text	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Connect text to what is important to the world	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Praise/Problems with text	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Enjoy/Not Enjoy	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts
Overall reaction	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	No connection 0 pts	10 pts

Standard Edited English/Writing conventions	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 3 pts	Errors detract from meaning/no post 0 pts	10 pts
Finished piece easy to read, polished	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Analyze a text for purpose and intended meaning	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Analyze a text for text-to-self, text-to-text, and text-to-world connections	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Create a Reader Response to text	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				100 pts

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5.7: Discussion Board - Reading Response Feedback

After completing your [Reading Response Student Choice](#), post your WordPress blog URL of the reading response and engage in discussion to gain feedback on your work.

Directions

1. Once you have completed the [Reading Response Student Choice](#), copy and paste the URL of your WordPress blog URL of the analysis into a new post in this discussion. You do not have to complete a Primary Post in the forum.
2. Review your classmates' Reading Response blog posts.
3. Respond to your classmates' posts discussing the following:
 - how well the assignment addresses the connection between the text and the classmate,
 - two things you liked about their reading response,
 - whether or not the reading response makes you want to review the student choice of text, and
 - one suggestion for improving the reading response.

Grading

Views of Writing KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Primary Post	Student addresses all directions; meets the 200 word count; and posts on time 10 pts	Student addresses some of the directions, and/or posts under 200 words 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Participate in a peer discussion of literature.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

6: Critical Reading

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Describe the main point, evidence, and assumptions of a text.
- Make inferences to comprehend a text's meaning.
- Identify propaganda techniques in text.
- Compose a critical reading paper of a contemporary work.
- Critically respond to classmates'.

Although understanding is the foundation of all reading experiences, it is not the ultimate goal of most college reading assignments. Your professors want you to read critically, which means moving beyond what the text says to asking questions about the how and why of the text's meaning. Reading critically means reading skeptically, not accepting everything a text says at face value, but wondering why a particular author made a particular argument in a particular way.

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[6.2: Reading Critically](#)

[6.3: Making Inferences](#)

[6.4: Propaganda](#)

[6.5: Discussion Board - WWII Propaganda Posters](#)

[6.6: Assignment - Critical Reading of an Essay](#)

[6.7: Discussion Board: Critical Reading of an Essay Feedback](#)

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6.1: Overview

Proficient readers often ask “what if?” questions to help them read more critically:

- What if the essay had started a different way?
- What if the author had included different evidence?
- What if the author had drawn a different conclusion?

The skills we use to for critical reading and writing are related to the skills we use for critical thinking.

Review “The Power of Critical Thinking” by Maria Mamah and consider the following:

- What did you think about the video?
- Did you watch it with a critical mind?
- Did you question it?
- Did you accept everything the woman said or did you wonder about why she made her arguments the way she did?



The Power Of Critical Thinking. **Authored by:** Maria Mamah. **Provided by:** Corvinus University of Budapest. **Located at:** <http://youtu.be/Hd4KrUH8Ky4>. **License:** Other. **License Terms:** Standard YouTube license

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6.2: Reading Critically

American author John Steinbeck wrote in his last work [*The Winter of Our Discontent*](#):

A story has as many versions as it has readers. Everyone takes what he wants or can from it and thus changes it to his measure. Some pick out parts and reject the rest, some strain the story through their mesh of prejudice, some paint it with their own delight.

When you read critically, you read not only to understand the meaning of the text, but also to question and analyze the text. You want to know not just what the text says, but also how and why it says what it says. Asking questions is one key strategy to help you read more critically. As you read a text critically, you are also reading skeptically.

A critical reader aims to answer two basic questions:

1. What is the author doing?
2. How well is the author doing it?

What is the author doing?

To answer “what is the author doing?” begin by carefully examining the following:

- What are the author’s claims (a claim is what the author says is true)?
- What is the evidence (evidence is what the author offers to support what they say is true)?
- What are the assumptions (assumptions are what the author says is true or will happen without giving any support)?

It may be helpful to try to see the argument from different angles:

- How else could the author have written this piece?
- What other kinds of evidence could have been used?
- What difference would that other evidence make?
- How has the author constructed his or her argument?

How well is the author doing it?

To answer “how well is the author doing it?” consider the following questions:

- How effective is the introduction? Why might the author have started the piece with this paragraph?
- Are the main ideas supported by solid evidence?
- What evidence does the author use? Is it effective? Useful? Can you think of other evidence?
- Is the author biased or neutral? How do you know?
- Does the conclusion effectively tie the argument together? Could you draw a different conclusion from this evidence?
- What kind of language is used? How would you describe the author’s style?
- How is the piece organized?

Asking Questions

Asking questions of a text helps proficient readers:

- Predict what a text will be about
- Identify confusing parts of the reading
- Clarify what confused them
- Develop a response to the text
- Understand the author’s purpose for writing a text

The easiest way to develop questions about a text is to be aware of your thinking process before, during, and after reading.

- What did you wonder about before you started reading?
- What did you think the text might be about?
- What questions did the text raise in your mind as you read?
- What seemed important or surprising?
- What were you wondering about when you finished reading?

- What did the author hope to accomplish in writing this text?
- Did he or she achieve that purpose?
- What remains unresolved in your mind?

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6.3: Making Inferences

Making inferences is a comprehension strategy used by proficient readers to “read between the lines,” make connections, and draw conclusions about the text’s meaning and purpose.

You already make inferences all of the time. For example, imagine you go over to a friend’s house and they point at the sofa and say, “Don’t sit there, Cindy came over with her baby again.” What could you logically conclude?

First, you know there must be a reason not to sit where your friend is pointing. Next, the reason not to sit there is related to the fact that Cindy just visited with her baby. You don’t know what exactly happened, but you can make an inference and don’t need to ask any more questions to know that you do not want to sit there.

Practice Making Inferences

Imagine you witness the following unrelated situations—what can you infer about each one?

1. You see a woman pushing a baby stroller down the street.
2. You are at a corner and see two parked cars at an intersection, and the driver in back starts honking his horn.
3. You are walking down the street, and suddenly a dog comes running out of an opened door with its tail between its legs.

For the first, you probably came up with something simple, such as there was a baby in the stroller.

For the second, you might have inferred that the first car should have started moving, or was waiting too long at the corner and holding up the second car.

For the third, you could reasonably guess that the dog had done something wrong and was afraid to get punished.

You do not know for 100% certainty that these inferences are true. If you checked 100 strollers, 99 times you would find a baby, but maybe one time you would find something else, like groceries.

Making Inferences as You Read

To make inferences from reading, take two or more details from the reading and see if you can draw a conclusion. Remember, making an inference is not just making a wild guess. You need to make a judgment that can be supported, just as you could reasonably infer there is a baby in a stroller, but not reasonably infer that there are groceries, even though both would technically be a “guess.”

When you are asked an inference question, go back over the reading and look for hints within the text, such as words that are directly related to the question you may be asked (such as for a multiple choice test) or words that indicate opinion.

Here is an example:

Hybrid cars are good for the environment, but they may not perform as well as cars that run only on gasoline. The Toyota Prius gets great gas mileage and has low emissions making it a good “green” option. However, many people think that it is unattractive. The Prius also cannot accelerate as quickly as other models, and cannot hold as many passengers as larger gas-fueled SUVs and vans. Compared to similar gas-fueled options, hybrid cars also cost more money up front. A new hybrid car costs almost \$3,500 more than the same car configured to run just on gasoline.

Which of the following can you infer from the passage?

1. hybrid cars are more dangerous than other options
2. Toyota is making a lot of money from the Prius
3. cars that use gasoline are going to destroy the environment
4. hybrid cars may not be the best choice for everyone

All four answers are about hybrid cars in some way, but none of the answers can be found directly from the text. Read through and see what hints you can find from the text.

You will notice right away that there is nothing about car safety in the passage at all, so you can eliminate choice 1.

Choice 2 is implied: if the car cost \$3,500 more than other cars, then Toyota would be making a lot of money by selling the car. But is it the most reasonable conclusion? To be sure, you need to go through all of the answers—don't just stop when you find one that looks okay.

You may think that choice 3 is true. After all, people want to make hybrid cars because they believe that emissions are contributing to environmental damage, but this is not mentioned in the paragraph. Even if you think it is true, the answer has to be supported by the text to be the correct answer to the problem.

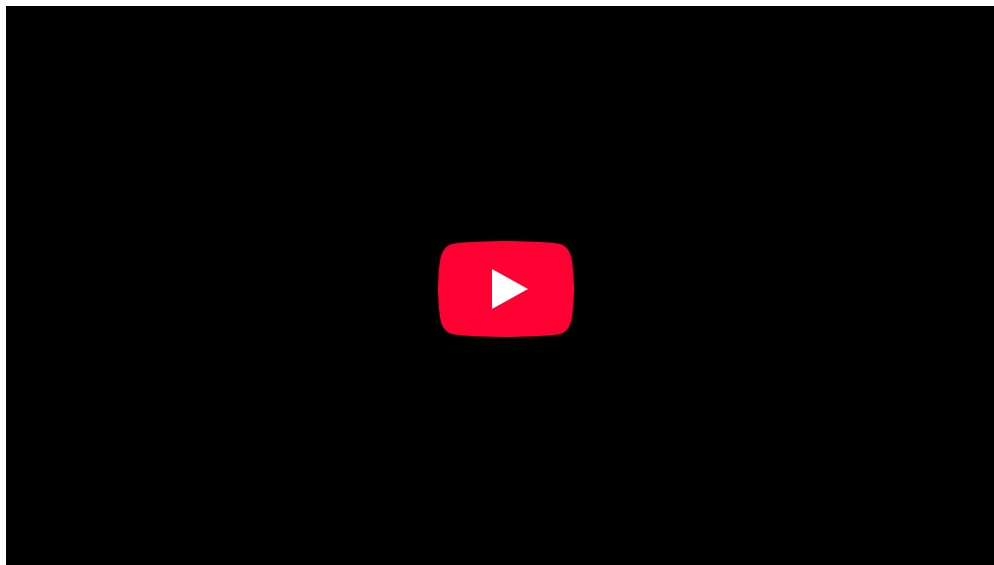
Choice 4 could be inferred from the text. If a person had a large family, was short on money, or needed a car that could accelerate quickly, then a hybrid might not be the best choice for them.

Now compare choice d with the other possible answer, choice 2. Now you are thinking choice 2 might not be as good an answer because you don't know how much it costs Toyota to make the cars, and you don't know how many they sell, so you can't reasonably infer that they are making a lot of money!

Choice 4 has to be the correct answer.

Inferences: Reading Between the Lines

Check out this video “Inference” by blumeanie07 that discusses a useful strategy to help you when making inferences while reading.



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6.4: Propaganda

Propaganda is a way to deliver a message that appeals to the emotions instead of presenting solid evidence to support a point. It is used by advertisers, salespeople, and politicians who may lack adequate facts to persuade people to support their point of view. Governments may use propaganda to rally support and influence people for a specific agenda, such as war. Part of being a critical reader is the ability to recognize these propaganda techniques.

Beyond Words

Being a critical reader extends far beyond paragraphs of printed words. Images can be read critically too. Some of the most common types of propaganda are found in images and videos.

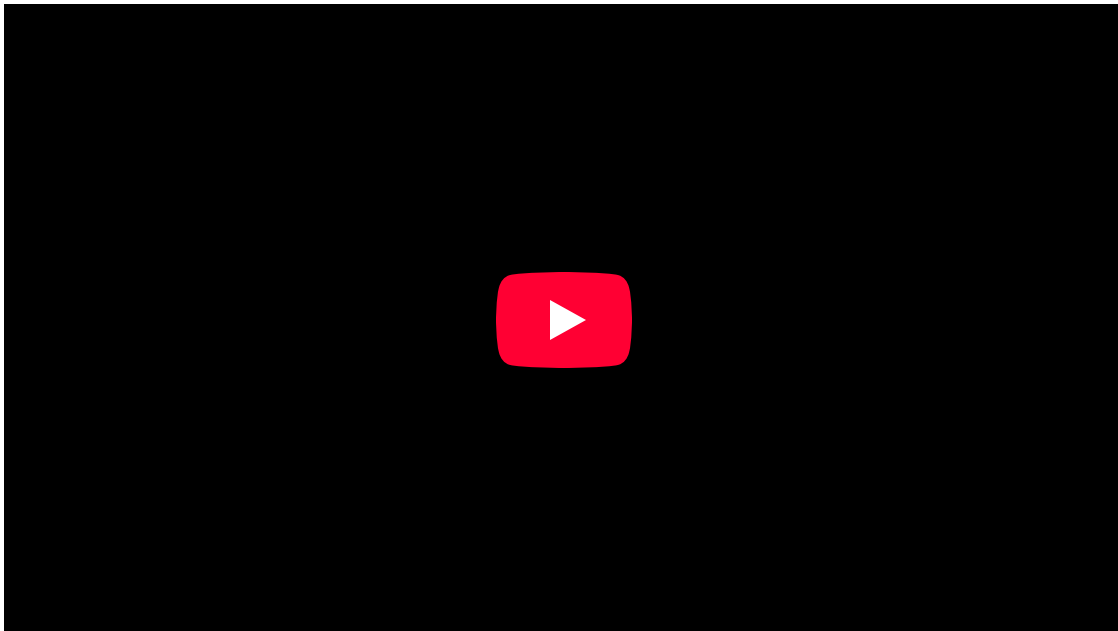
Review the types of propaganda and examples below while thinking about the following:

- Who is the creator of these images?
- Why were they created?
- Who is the target audience?
- What biases are they portraying?
- What is the perspective of the creators?

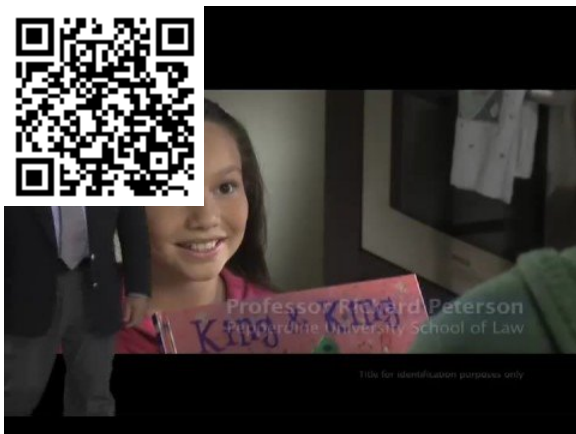
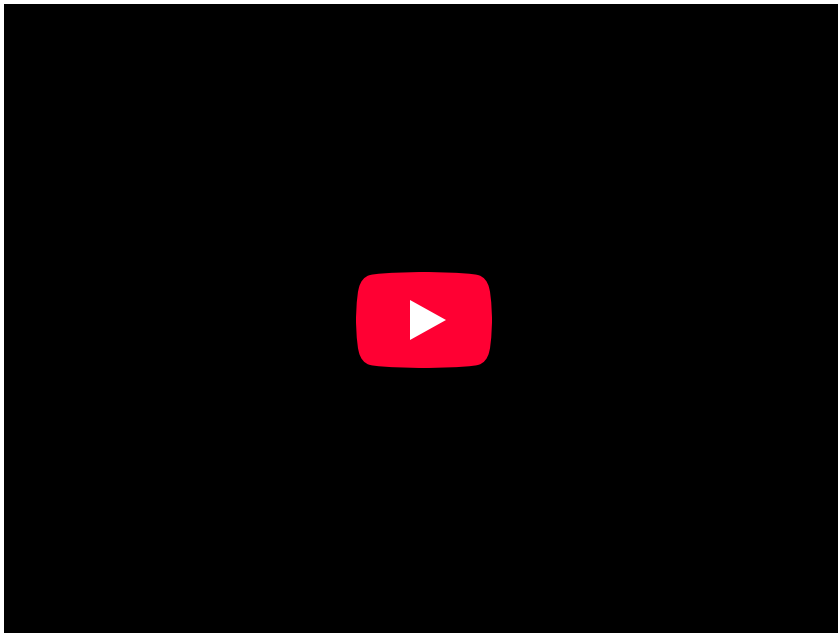
Bandwagon

This form of propaganda presents the idea that “everybody’s doing it” so you should “jump on the bandwagon” and do what everyone else is doing too.

In this ad, “everyone”— or 20 million people plus the elderly man—are playing *Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 2*, so to be with everyone you should play the game too.

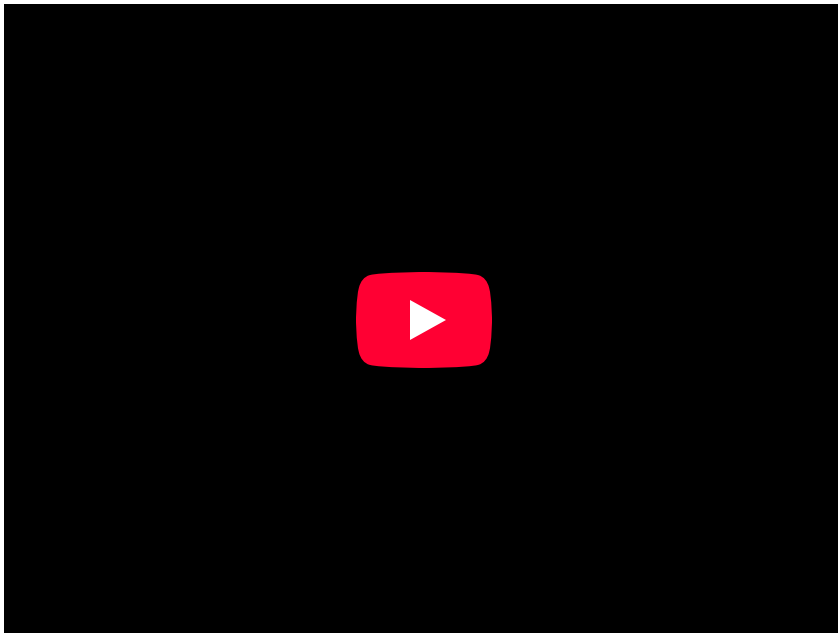


A type of “logical fallacy,” this form of propaganda presents data or issues that, while compelling, have nothing to do with the argument. This ad argues that parents should control what their children learn in school, but what children are learning in school really has nothing to do with the issue, which is whether or not to legalize gay marriage.



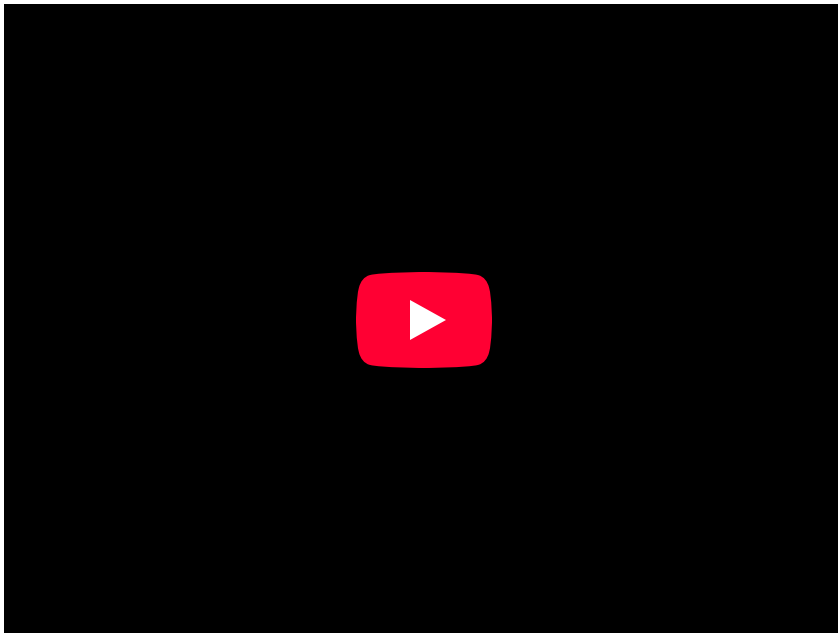
Glittering Generality

This form of propaganda applies emotional words to a product or idea that presents no concrete argument or analysis. This John McCain political ad applies the words “reform, prosperity, and peace” to the “McCain for President” campaign.



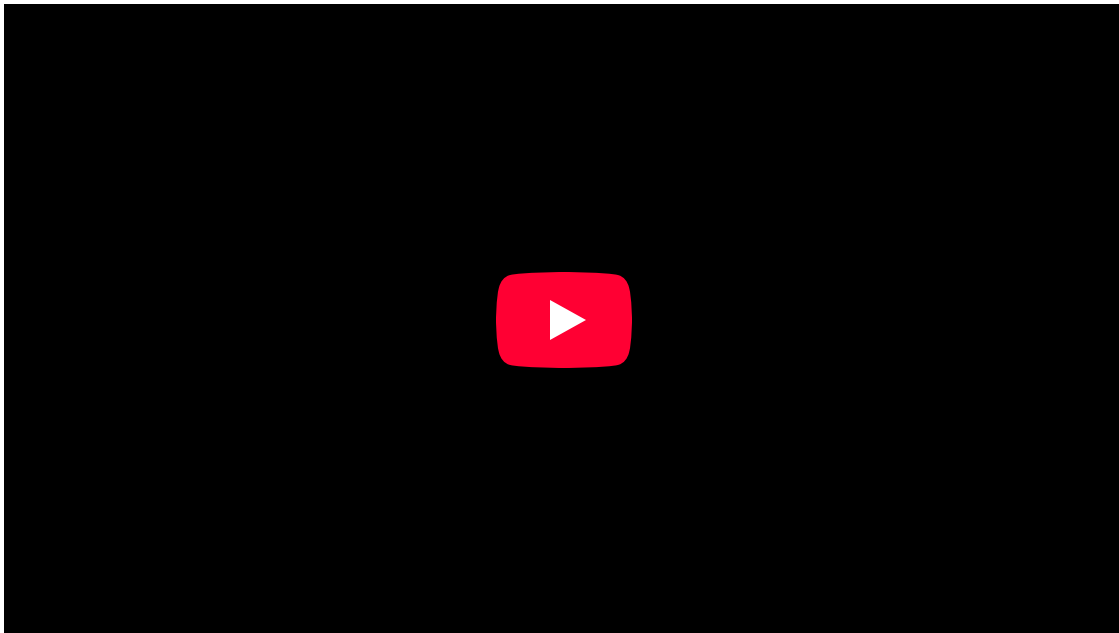
Testimonial

This form of propaganda features an expert, person of authority, or respected public figure who supports the argument and encourages others to accept the opinions and beliefs as their own. In this ad, Michael Jordan, arguably one of the greatest basketball athletes in history, simply drinks Gatorade, which is an easy way for anyone—regardless of how well they play basketball—to “be like Mike.”



Stereotype

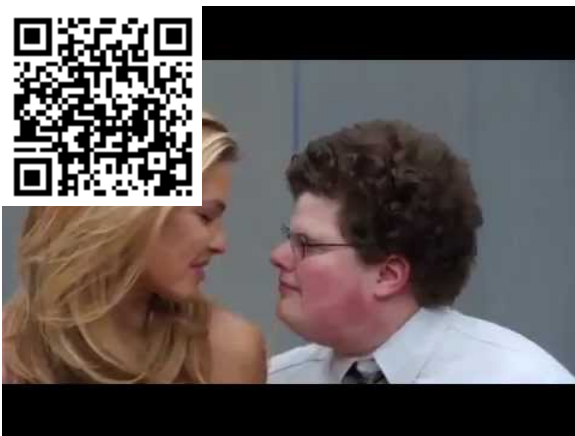
This form of propaganda arouses prejudices in an audience by labeling the object of the propaganda campaign as something the target audience fears, hates, or even finds desirable. In this ad, the viewer is led to believe that people who have a Volkswagen “experience” will in turn become a Caribbean stereotype, complete with an accent and a “no worry” attitude even if it’s a bad Monday at the office.



Beautiful People

This type of propaganda features attractive, happy, or famous people associated with an idea to make other people think that if they buy a product or follow a certain ideology, they too will be attractive, happy, and successful.

This ad with supermodel Bar Refaeli associates not only sex appeal but also smarts if you buy your domain and website from Go Daddy.



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- Go Daddy Super Bowl 2013 Commercial Bar Refaeli kisses Jesse Heiman with Danica Patrick. **Authored by:** JungleJuice2000. **Provided by:** Go Daddy. **Located at:** <http://youtu.be/iE6TTYfRiAg>. **License:** *Other*. **License Terms:** Standard YouTube license

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6.5: Discussion Board - WWII Propaganda Posters

During times of war, governments often resort to propaganda. For this discussion, you will apply what you know about [critical reading](#), [making inferences](#), and [propaganda](#) to review [propaganda posters](#) generated during the time of [World War II](#).

Directions

1. Choose three of the [WWII propaganda posters](#) to review.
2. Open a new Google Doc and copy and paste the URL of each of the three posters into the doc.
3. Under the URL of each poster, apply what you know about critical reading by answer the following about each poster:
 - Who is the creator of these images?
 - Why were they created?
 - Who is the target audience?
 - What biases are they portraying?
 - What is the perspective of the creators of the posters?
 - How effective are the posters in persuading someone to think, believe, or act in a certain way about something?
4. Copy and paste the responses to the propaganda posters you developed in the Google Doc as your Primary Post in the discussion.
5. Review your classmates' posts.
6. Thoughtfully respond to your classmates about whether you agree or disagree with their responses to the propaganda posters.

Grading

Propaganda Poster KEEP						
Criteria	Ratings					Points
Primary Post	Student cites three posters, pastes the URL of each poster, and responds to all six critical reading bullets. 10 pts	Student cites two posters, pastes the URL of each poster, and responds to all six critical reading bullets. 7 pts	Student cites one posters, pastes the URL of each poster, and responds to all six critical reading bullets. 6 pts	Student does not fully post about the posters. 3 pts	Student does not post. 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' Primary Posts and meets 100 word posts for each response. 10 pts		Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's Primary Post, and/or does not meet 100 word counts. 5 pts		Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Identify propaganda techniques in text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts		Meets expectations 0 pts		Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS						20 pts

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6.6: Assignment - Critical Reading of an Essay

For this assignment, create a Critical Reading of an essay about a text from one of the contemporary authors listed below.

Directions

- Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
- Select ONE essay from the contemporary author sites linked here:
 - [Toure](#) (video essays)
 - [Elif Batuman](#)
 - [Ira Chernus](#)
 - [bell hooks](#)
 - [Susan Orlean](#)
 - [Malcolm Gladwell](#)
- Review the strategies listed on the [Reading Critically](#) page.
- Create a Critical Reading of the essay of your choice in 500–700 words in a new Google Doc.
 - Cite the author and the text in your paper
 - Pay close attention to the author’s argument, meaning, evidence, logic, and assumptions.
 - Compose a critical reading response of the essay and be sure to answer: What is the author doing?
 - Also, be sure to answer: How well is he or she doing it?
- Copy and paste your Critical Reading of an essay in a new post on your WordPress blog.
- Submit the URL of your WordPress blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 100

Submitting: a website URL

Critical Reading of an Essay KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Identifies author and work	Identifies 5 pts	Does not identify 0 pts		5 pts
Answers “what is the author doing?”	Proficient 15 pts	Developing 11 pts	Lacks answer 0 pts	15 pts
Answers “how well is the author doing it?”	Proficient 15 pts	Developing 11 pts	Lacks answer 0 pts	15 pts
Examines the author’s claims	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Examines the author’s evidence	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Examines the author’s assumptions	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts

Reviews the argument from different angles	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No review 0 pts	8 pts
Examines the effectiveness of the introduction/c onclusion	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Examines how the piece is organized	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Demonstrates an understanding of the author's purpose	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Standard Edited English/Writin g conventions	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	Errors detract from meaning/no post 0 pts	5 pts
Finished piece easy to read, polished, posted in WordPress blog site	Proficient 4 pts	Developing 3 pts	Needs more work 0 pts	4 pts
Describe the main point, evidence, and assumptions of a text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Make inferences to comprehend a text's meaning.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Compose a critical reading paper of a contemporary work.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				100

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6.7: Discussion Board: Critical Reading of an Essay Feedback

After completing your [Critical Reading of an Essay](#), post your WordPress blog URL of the critical reading and engage in discussion to gain feedback on your work.

Directions

1. Once you have completed the [Critical Reading of an Essay](#), copy and paste the URL of your WordPress blog URL of the critical reading into a new post in this discussion. You do not have to complete a Primary Post in the forum.
2. Review your classmates' Critical Reading of an Essay blog posts.
3. Respond to your classmates' posts discussing the following:
 - how well the essay addresses the critical reading question: *What is the author doing?*
 - how well the essay addresses the critical reading question: *How well is he or she doing it?*
 - two things you liked about their critical reading of an essay,
 - whether or not the critical reading makes you want to read the essay selection, and
 - one suggestion for improving the critical reading.

Grading

Critical Reading of an Essay Feedback KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Blog URL	Student posts Critical Reading blog URL 10 pts	Student does not post URL 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Compose a critical reading paper of a contemporary work.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

7: Rhetorical Analysis

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Analyze an author's effectiveness in achieving intended purpose.
- Develop a rhetorical analysis of a visual text.
- Apply strategies for improving writing responses.
- Discuss how classmates' evaluated rhetorical message in text.

Rhetorical analysis is a tool for deeper critical reading. When you analyze a text rhetorically, you consider the overall situation and context of the writing and how the needs and constraints of the writing situation may have guided the author's choices. Rhetorical analysis helps us look at the text itself but also outside the text at other aspects of the writing situation—context, author, audience, genre—that influenced the way this particular text was written.

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7.1: Overview

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Analyze an author's effectiveness in achieving intended purpose.
- Develop a rhetorical analysis of a visual text.
- Apply strategies for improving writing responses.
- Discuss how classmates' evaluated rhetorical message in text.

Rhetorical analysis is a tool for deeper critical reading. When you analyze a text rhetorically, you consider the overall situation and context of the writing and how the needs and constraints of the writing situation may have guided the author's choices. Rhetorical analysis helps us look at the text itself but also outside the text at other aspects of the writing situation—context, author, audience, genre—that influenced the way this particular text was written.

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7.2: What is Rhetorical Analysis?

We have heard that “you can’t judge a book by its cover,” but, in fact, we do it all the time. Daily we find ourselves in situations where we are forced to make snap judgments. Each day we meet different people, encounter unfamiliar situations, and see media that asks us to do, think, buy, and act in all sorts of ways.

In fact, our saturation in media and its images is one of the reasons why learning to do rhetorical analysis is so important. The more we know about how to analyze situations and draw informed conclusions, the better we can become about making savvy judgments about the people, situations, and media we encounter.

Media and Rhetoric

Media is one of the most important places where this kind of analysis needs to happen. *Rhetoric*—the way we use language and images to persuade—is what makes media work. Think of all the media you see and hear every day: Twitter, television shows, web pages, billboards, text messages, podcasts, and more! Media is constantly asking you to buy something, act in some way, believe something to be true, or interact with others in a specific manner. Understanding rhetorical messages is essential to help us become informed consumers, but it also helps evaluate the ethics of messages, how they affect us personally, and how they affect society.

Take, for example, a commercial for men’s deodorant that tells you that you’ll be irresistible to women if you use their product. This campaign doesn’t just ask you to buy the product, though. It also asks you to trust the company’s credibility, or *ethos*, and to believe the messages they send about how men and women interact, about sexuality, and about what constitutes a healthy body. You have to decide whether or not you will choose to buy the product and how you will choose to respond to the messages that the commercial sends.

Because media rhetoric surrounds us, it is important to understand how rhetoric works. If we refuse to stop and think about how and why it persuades us, we can become mindless consumers who buy into arguments about what makes us value ourselves and what makes us happy.

Rhetoric as Social Influence

Our worlds are full of these kinds of social influences. As we interact with other people and with media, we are continually creating and interpreting rhetoric. In the same way that you decide how to process, analyze or ignore these messages, you create them. You probably think about what your clothing will communicate as you go to a job interview or get ready for a date. You are also using rhetoric when you try to persuade your parents to send you money or your friends to see the movie that interests you. When you post to your blog or tweet you are using rhetoric.

Most of our actions are persuasive in nature. What we choose to wear (tennis shoes vs. flip flops), where we shop (Whole Foods Market vs. Wal-Mart), what we eat (organic vs. fast food), or even the way we send information (snail mail vs. text message) can work to persuade others.

Chances are you have grown up learning to interpret and analyze these types of rhetoric. They become so commonplace that we don’t realize how often and how quickly we are able to perform this kind of rhetorical analysis. When your teacher walked in on the first day of class, you probably didn’t think to yourself, “I think I’ll do some rhetorical analysis on her clothing and draw some conclusions about what kind of personality she might have and whether I think I’ll like her.” And, yet, you probably were able to come up with some conclusions based on the evidence you had.

However, when this same teacher hands you an advertisement, photograph or article and asks you to write a rhetorical analysis of it, you might have been baffled or felt a little overwhelmed. The good news is that many of the analytical processes that you already use to interpret the rhetoric around you are the same ones that you’ll use for these assignments.

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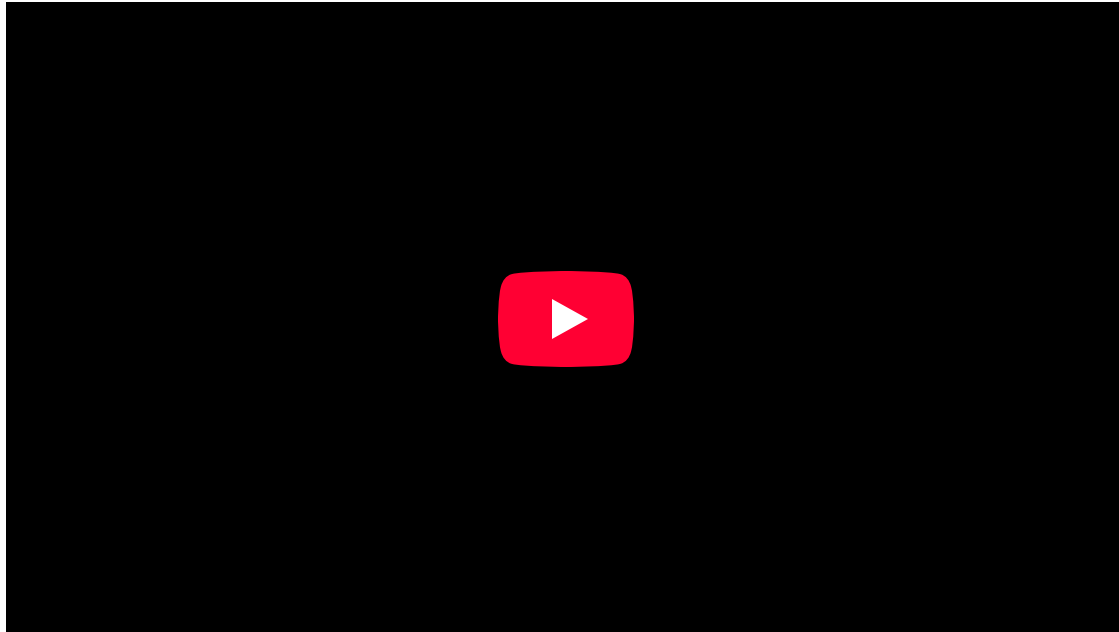
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7.3: Assignment - Rhetorical Analysis and Media

For this assignment, review how media uses rhetoric.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric on this page.
2. Watch the following *Mad Men* advertising pitch for “The Kodak Carousel” and think about the way the advertisers use images and language to persuade...this is rhetoric!



3.

ng questions in a Google Doc:

the advertising pitch that is supposed to connect with the public and get them to buy the product, in this case the Kodak Carousel?
2. What is it about nostalgia (Don Draper said in Greek it means “the pain of an old wound”) that is more powerful than memory?
3. Is the advertising pitch by Don Draper effective at persuading the public? Why or why not?
4. Copy and paste your final answers into a new WordPress blog post.
5. Submit the URL of your blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 40

Submitting: a website URL

Rhetorical Analysis and Media KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Describe an author's point of view and tone	Exceeds expectations 5 pts	Meets expectations 3 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	5 pts

Analyze an author's effectiveness in achieving intended purpose	Exceeds expectations 5 pts	Meets expectations 3 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	5 pts
Explains why advertising pitch will appeal to consumer	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts		10 pts
Explains what it is about nostalgia that is more powerful than memory	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts		10 pts
Explains why advertising pitch is or is not effective at persuasion	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts		10 pts
TOTAL POINTS				40 pts

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7.4: Developing a Rhetorical Analysis

One of the first places to start when developing a rhetorical analysis is context. Rhetorical messages always occur in a specific situation or context. The president's speech might respond to a specific global event, like an economic summit; that's part of the context. You choose your clothing depending on where you are going or what you are doing; that's context. A television commercial comes on during specific programs and at specific points of the day; that's context. A billboard is placed in a specific part of the community; that's context, too.

Identify the Rhetorical Situation: Exigence, Audience, Constraints

In an article called [“The Rhetorical Situation,” Lloyd Bitzer](#) argues that there are three parts to understanding the context of a rhetorical moment: exigence, audience and constraints.

Exigence is the circumstance or condition that invites a response; or, in other words, rhetorical discourse is usually responding to some kind of problem. You can begin to understand a piece's exigence by asking, “What is this rhetoric responding to?” “What might have happened to make the rhetor (the person who creates the rhetoric) respond in this way?” The exigence can be extremely complex, like the need for a new Supreme Court justice, or it can be much simpler, like receiving an email that asks you where you and your friends should go for your road trip this weekend. Understanding the exigence is important because it helps you begin to discover the purpose of the rhetoric. It helps you understand what the discourse is trying to accomplish.

Another part of the rhetorical context is *audience*, those who are the (intended or unintended) recipients of the rhetorical message. The audience should be able to respond to the exigence. In other words, the audience should be able to help address the problem. You might be very frustrated with your campus's requirement that all first-year students purchase a meal plan for on-campus dining. You might even send an email to a good friend back home voicing that frustration. However, if you want to address the exigence of the meal plans, the most appropriate audience would be the person/office on campus that oversees meal plans. Your friend back home cannot solve the problem (though she may be able to offer sympathy or give you some good suggestions), but the person who can change the meal plan requirements is probably on campus. Rhetors make all sorts of choices based on their audience. Audience can determine the type of language used, the formality of the discourse, the medium or delivery of the rhetoric, and even the types of reasons used to make the rhetor's argument. Understanding the audience helps you begin to see and understand the rhetorical moves that the rhetor makes.

The last piece of the rhetorical situation is the *constraints*. The constraints of the rhetorical situation are those things that limit the way the discourse is delivered or communicated. Constraints may be something as simple as your instructor limiting your proposal to one thousand words, or they may be far more complex like the kinds of language you need to use to persuade a certain community.

Identify the Argument: Logos, Pathos, Ethos

The rhetorical situation is just the beginning of your analysis, though. What you really want to understand is the argument—what the rhetor wants you to believe or do and how he or she goes about that persuasion. Effective argumentation has been talked about for centuries. In the fourth century BCE, Aristotle was teaching the men of Athens how to persuade different kinds of audiences in different kinds of rhetorical situations. Aristotle articulated three “artistic appeals” that a rhetor could draw on to make a case—logos, pathos, and ethos.

Logos is commonly defined as argument from reason, and it usually appeals to an audience's intellectual side. As audiences we want to know the “facts of the matter,” and logos helps present these—statistics, data, and logical statements.

Few of us are persuaded only with our mind, though. Even if we intellectually agree with something, it is difficult to get us to act unless we are also persuaded in our heart. This kind of appeal to emotion is called *pathos*. Pathetic appeals (as rhetoric that draws on pathos is called) used alone without logos and ethos can come across as emotionally manipulative or overly sentimental, but are very powerful when used in conjunction with the other two appeals. Pathos can also be a very effective appeal if the rhetor has to persuade the audience in a very short amount of time, which is why it is used heavily in print advertisements, billboards, or television commercials.

The appeal that makes things seem real and approachable contributes to the ethos. *Ethos* refers to the credibility of the *rhetor*—which can be a person or an organization. A rhetor can develop credibility in many ways. The tone of the writing and whether that tone is appropriate for the context helps build a writer's ethos, as does the accuracy of the information or the visual presentation of the rhetoric.

Claims and Assumptions

Aristotle's artistic appeals are not the only way to understand the argument of rhetoric. You might choose to look at the *claim* or the unstated assumptions of a piece; someone else might consider the visual appeal of the rhetoric, like the font, page layout, types of paper, or images; another person might focus on the language use and the specific word choice and sentence structure of a piece. Logos, pathos, and ethos can provide a nice framework for analysis, but there are numerous ways to understand how a piece of rhetoric persuades (or fails to persuade).

Looking at the context and components of a piece of rhetoric often isn't enough, though, because it is important to draw conclusions about the rhetoric—does it successfully respond to the exigence? Is it an ethical approach? Is it persuasive? These kinds of questions let you begin to create your own claims, your own rhetoric, as you take a stand on what other people say, do, or write.

Asking Questions

Use these questions to guide you along as you begin to conduct a rhetorical analysis.

What is the rhetorical situation?

- What occasion gives rise to the need or opportunity for persuasion?
- What is the historical occasion that would give rise to the composition of this text?

Who is the author/speaker?

- How does he or she establish ethos (personal credibility)?
- Does he/she come across as knowledgeable? fair?
- Does the speaker's reputation convey a certain authority?

What is his/her intention in speaking?

- To attack or defend?
- To exhort or dissuade from certain action?
- To praise or blame?
- To teach, to delight, or to persuade?

Who make up the audience?

- Who is the intended audience?
- What values does the audience hold that the author or speaker appeals to?
- Who have been or might be secondary audiences?
- If this is a work of fiction, what is the nature of the audience within the fiction?

What is the content of the message?

- Can you summarize the main idea?
- What are the principal lines of reasoning or kinds of arguments used?
- What topics of invention are employed?
- How does the author or speaker appeal to reason? to emotion?

What is the form in which it is conveyed?

- What is the structure of the communication; how is it arranged?
- What oral or literary genre is it following?
- What figures of speech (schemes and tropes) are used?
- What kind of style and tone is used and for what purpose?

How do form and content correspond?

- Does the form complement the content?
- What effect could the form have, and does this aid or hinder the author's intention?

Does the message/speech/text succeed in fulfilling the author's or speaker's intentions?

- For whom?

- Does the author/speaker effectively fit his/her message to the circumstances, times, and audience?
- Can you identify the responses of historical or contemporary audiences?

What does the nature of the communication reveal about the culture that produced it?

- What kinds of values or customs would the people have that would produce this?
- How do the allusions, historical references, or kinds of words used place this in a certain time and location?

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- The Forest of Rhetoric: silva rhetoricae. **Authored by:** Gideon O. Burton. **Provided by:** Brigham Young University. **Located at:** <http://rhetoric.byu.edu/>. **License:** [CC BY: Attribution](#)

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7.5: Assignment - Backpacks vs. Briefcases

For this activity, you will demonstrate your ability to make connections with the text and critically think, read, and write. This work will serve as the foundation for understanding what a Rhetorical Analysis is as well as how to apply the knowledge to your own Rhetorical Analysis work.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Download [Backpacks vs Briefcases: Steps Toward Rhetorical Analysis](#).
3. Annotate the text.
4. Answer the following questions in a Google Doc:
 1. What are the implications of rhetorical analysis? (p. 3, p. 46)
 2. What is the “rhetorical situation”? (p. 5, p.48)
 3. What is the argument in rhetorical analysis? (p. 9, p. 52)
 4. What does context have to do with Rhetorical Analysis? (p.12, p.55)
 5. Why is rhetorical analysis important in college? (p.14, p.57)
 6. What are examples of rhetoric that you see and hear on a daily basis?
 7. What are some ways that you create rhetoric?
5. Copy and paste your final answers into a new WordPress blog post.
6. Submit the URL of your blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 70

Submitting: a website URL

Backpacks vs. Briefcases KEEP			
<i>Criteria</i>	<i>Ratings</i>		<i>Points</i>
Explains Implications of Rhetorical Analysis	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Defines the Rhetorical Situation	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Explains the Argument in Rhetorical Analysis	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Explains What Content Has to Do with Rhetorical Analysis	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Explains Why Rhetorical Analysis is Important in College	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts

Offers Examples of Rhetorical Analysis in Life	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Explains Ways Student Creates Rhetoric	Full marks 10 pts	No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Apply strategies for improving writing responses.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts
TOTAL POINTS			70 pts

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7.6: Assignment - Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad

For this activity, you will create a Rhetorical Analysis of an advertisement of your choice.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Select an advertisement of your choice.
3. Review the strategies listed on the [What Is Rhetorical Analysis?](#) and [Developing a Rhetorical Analysis](#) pages as well as [Backpacks vs Briefcases](#).
 - Create a Rhetorical Analysis of 750 Words of the advertisement of your choice in a new Google Doc.
 - Cite the author and advertising source
 - Use the techniques, strategies, and language in [Backpacks vs Briefcases](#)
 - Be sure to cite all sources.
4. Copy and paste your Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad in a new post on your WordPress blog.
5. Submit the URL of your WordPress blog post to your instructor.

Grading

Points: 100

Submitting: a website URL

Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Identifies author and work	Identifies 5 pts	Does not identify 0 pts		5 pts
Identifies rhetorical situation/context (p. 48 in Backpacks)	Proficient 15 pts	Developing 11 pts	Lacks answer 0 pts	15 pts
Identifies argument (p. 52 in Backpacks)	Proficient 15 pts	Developing 11 pts	Lacks answer 0 pts	15 pts
Identifies author's intent/purpose	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Identifies audience	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Identifies content of message	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Identifies form/style/tone	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No review 0 pts	8 pts

Examines the effectiveness of the introduction/conclusion	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Examines how the piece is organized	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No examination 0 pts	8 pts
Demonstrates an understanding of the author's purpose	Proficient 8 pts	Developing 6 pts	No understanding 0 pts	8 pts
Standard Edited English/Writing conventions	Proficient 5 pts	Developing 4 pts	Errors detract from meaning/no post 0 pts	5 pts
Finished piece easy to read, polished, posted in WordPress blog site	Proficient 4 pts	Developing 3 pts	Needs more work 0 pts	4 pts
Analyze an author's effectiveness in achieving intended purpose	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Develop a rhetorical analysis of a visual text	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Describe an author's point of view and tone	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				100 pts

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7.7: Discussion Board - Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad Feedback

After completing your [Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad](#), post your WordPress blog URL of the analysis and engage in discussion to gain feedback on your work.

Directions

1. Once you have completed the [Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad](#), copy and paste the URL of your WordPress blog URL of the analysis into a new post in this discussion. You do not have to complete a Primary Post in the forum.
2. Review your classmates' Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad blog posts.
3. Respond to your classmates' posts discussing the following:
 - how well the assignment addresses point of view and tone,
 - two things you liked about their rhetorical analysis,
 - whether or not the rhetorical analysis makes you want to review the ad, and
 - one suggestion for improving the rhetorical analysis.

Grading

Rhetorical Analysis Feedback KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Blog URL	Student posts Rhetorical Analysis blog URL 10 pts	Student does not post URL 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Secondary Post	Student thoughtfully responds to 2 classmates' primary posts, meets the 100 word count for each response, and posts on time 10 pts	Student thoughtfully responds to 1 classmate's primary posts, and/or does not meet 100 word count 5 pts	Student does not post 0 pts	10 pts
Discuss how classmates' evaluated rhetorical message in text.	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts	Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS				20 pts

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

8: Reflection and Portfolio

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing this module, you should be able to:

- Produce a reflective paper on individual growth in the course.
- Revisit and revise selected work.
- Develop course schedule for next semester.

Reflection is a process of careful thought or deliberation. When we reflect, we think about something that has happened in the past and examine its significance and meaning. In this module, reflect on your work in this course to understand and articulate what you have achieved and where you will go from here.

[8.1: Overview](#)

[8.2: Portfolio Part I - Reflection](#)

[8.3: Portfolio Part II - Best Work](#)

[8.4: Portfolio Part III - Post-Course Plans](#)

[8.5: Assignment - Organize and Submit the Portfolio](#)

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8.2: Portfolio Part I - Reflection

For this section of the portfolio, think about the following:

- How have you changed and grown as a college student?
- How have you changed and grown as a writer?
- How have you changed and grown as a reader?
- How have you changed and grown with technology skills?
- What skills or strategies do you now use that you didn't before this class?
- How do you struggle successfully with academic assignments?
- How do you feel about academic expectations now compared to the beginning of the course?

Then, in a Google Doc, create a reflective writing.

A suggested format is as follows:

Introduction

A few sentences about where you came from, why you chose this institution, and how you feel now about college and academic writing.

Body

Reflect about the first day of this class. What were your impressions of the course, your instructor, the institution? Were you excited to begin your studies? How did you feel about the expectations set forth by your friends/parents/instructors/yourself?

Reflect about a few weeks ago at midterm. How did you feel about your progress? Were you able to keep up with the pace of the course and the assignments or did you fall behind? If you had difficulty keeping up in class, was there a reason you can pinpoint that may have contributed to not keeping up with class? How did you feel about your writing skills at midterm?

Reflect about what activities and assignments you found most useful and write about how these activities/assignments helped you grow as a student.

Conclusion

Now that you are at the end of the course, do you feel more prepared now to meet the challenges of college and life beyond? What recommendations do you have for new college students beginning this course? What is your definition of success for yourself in this course? What is your definition of success beyond this course? How will you know you've achieved success?

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8.3: Portfolio Part II - Best Work

This section of the portfolio includes a short reflection as well as a final revision of your work (hence the Best Work title!) as evidence of your most polished pieces created in class.

Directions

Reading Response

- Revisit [Reading Response Student Choice](#)
- Revise, aiming for perfection.
- Write a 25 word reflection on the following:
 - What revision(s) did you make?
 - What did you learn?
 - How will what you learned assist you in the future?

Critical Reading

- Revisit [Critical Reading of an Essay](#)
- Revise, aiming for perfection.
- Write a 25 word reflection on the following:
 - What revision(s) did you make?
 - What did you learn?
 - How will what you learned assist you in the future?

Rhetorical Analysis

- Revisit [Rhetorical Analysis with an Ad](#)
- Revise, aiming for perfection.
- Write a 25 word reflection on the following:
 - What revision(s) did you make?
 - What did you learn?
 - How will what you learned assist you in the future?

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8.4: Portfolio Part III - Post-Course Plans

This section of your portfolio communicates what your plans are after this course.

Directions

Choose only one of the categories below that best fits your plans and complete the following as directed.

Category 1

For continuing students at this college

- Review your course schedule for the current semester via the student information system
- Decide whether you want to change/add your current discipline of study, major, and/or minor. If you plan any of these changes, contact Student Services.
- Download a copy of your current schedule.
- Register for or review your next semester classes. If you need help, contact Student Services.
- Download a copy of your next semester schedule.
- Upload digital copies of both your current and next semester schedules to a Google Doc.

Category 2

For future college students not attending this institution

- Review your course schedule for the current semester via the student information system.
- Download a copy of your current schedule.
- Register for your next semester classes at the school you do plan to attend.
- Download a copy of your next semester schedule from the other institution you plan to attend.
- Upload digital copies of both your current and next semester schedules to a Google Doc.
- Contact the Student Services for assistance with withdrawing from the college.

Category 3

For those unsure or not planning to attend college next semester

- Open a Google Doc
- Write a 100 Word response describing what you plan to do instead of college for next semester.

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8.5: Assignment - Organize and Submit the Portfolio

For this assignment, you will organize and submit your portfolio.

Directions

1. Review the grading rubric as listed on this page.
2. Create a new Google Doc.
3. Set the Share settings to “Anyone with the link.”
4. Title the file as follows: First Name Last Name: Portfolio
5. Review the [sample](#) for reference
6. Review the [screencast](#).
7. Arrange your portfolio as described below (and here is a):
 - Cover page
 - Title of the Portfolio
 - Your First and Last Name
 - Institution Name
 - Date
 - On a new page for each section (use Insert, Page Break in Google Doc):
 - Reflective Writing
 - Review [Portfolio Part I: Reflection](#)
 - Include 750 Word Reflection
 - Best Work
 - Review [Portfolio Part II: Best Work](#)
 - Include:
 - 25 Word reflection about your Reading Response
 - Paste your revised best Journal
 - 25 Word reflection about your Critical Reading
 - Paste your revised Discussion Post
 - 25 Word reflection about your Rhetorical Analysis
 - Paste the URL of your best Prezi Project
 - Post-Course Plans
 - Review [Portfolio Part III: Post Course Plans](#)
 - Include:
 - Current semester schedule
 - Next semester schedule **or** 100 Word Alternative Plans
8. When you are finished developing your portfolio in the Google Doc, copy the URL
9. Paste the URL of your portfolio in the submission.

Grading

Points: 200

Submitting: a website URL

Organize and Submit Portfolio KEEP				
Criteria	Ratings			Points
Reflects on Growth as a Student	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts

Reflects on Growth as a Writer	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Growth as a Reader	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Growth with Technology Skills	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Skills/Strategi es Using Now	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Successfully Struggling with Academic Assignments	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Beliefs/Feelins About Academic Expectations	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Revises Reading Response	Proficient 20 pts	Developing 10 pts	No reflection 0 pts	20 pts	
Revises Critical Reading	Proficient 20 pts	Developing 10 pts	No reflection 0 pts	20 pts	
Revises Rhetorical Analysis	Proficient 20 pts	Developing 10 pts	No reflection 0 pts	20 pts	
Reflects on Reading Response	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Critical Reading	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Reflects on Rhetorical Analysis	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 5 pts	No reflection 0 pts	10 pts	
Uploads Current Schedule	Schedule included 15 pts		Not included 0 pts		15 pts

Uploads Next Semester Schedule or Plans	Schedule/plans included 15 pts		Not included 0 pts	15 pts	
Presentation	Proficient 10 pts	Developing 6 pts		No marks 0 pts	10 pts
Produce a reflective paper on individual growth in the course	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts		Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Revisit and revise selected work	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts		Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
Develop course schedule for next semester	Exceeds expectations 0 pts	Meets expectations 0 pts		Does not meet expectations 0 pts	0 pts
TOTAL POINTS					200 pts

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I

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